

Physical Education & Gym

Year 6

Cambridge Primary

Student Manual





Physical Education

Year 6 · Student Manual

The High Fields

A student book for Upper Primary, written for pupils of about ten to eleven years old. Year 3 stepped onto a measured track. Year 4 put the whole school on the sports day field at once. This year you go up the hill, through the five-bar gate, to the fields where the oldest ones work.

Six places on the high fields: the Five-Bar Gate, the Dry Stone Wall, the Orchard, the Hay Meadow, the Tack Room and the Hill Spring. Pip, Bramble, Sorrel, Tuft, Willow and Rowan are all here again, three years older, and this year they write the morning down before anybody moves.

Anybody can climb to the bar they already fit on. The interesting question is which bar you are working on, and whether you could say so out loud.

Physical Education · Year 6

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Safety, and it is not a formality. This is a Physical Education book, so almost every task moves a body through a space, and several tasks in this book ask a pupil to choose a harder version for themselves. Every task assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and apparatus set out and tested by an adult. The teacher carries out their own risk assessment and follows the school's safety policy. Where a task carries a particular risk, the book says so on the page in a violet **Stay safe** panel. Those panels are instructions, not advice.

Square codes. Both square codes in this book were scanned, and both addresses answered correctly, when this edition went to press. An adult holds the device and opens the page. Pages outside Prime School's control may move or close, and Prime School is not responsible for their content.

Inclusion. Every comparison in this book asks a pupil to look at their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body to succeed. Distances, heights, weights and timings are all adjustable, and the gates exist so that a pupil works at the bar they are actually on. The objective is control, not size.

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This edition carries Unit 1 only. The five units marked **to come** are planned and written into the scheme; they follow in the complete book.



The high fields, before anybody walks up. The gate is shut and latched, the clay ground inside it has been swept, and there is still dew on the hay. Look past the wall: the orchard, the tack room and the spring are the other places in this book. Six places, six units.

Up at the high fields

You have been doing this subject for six years, so let us skip the part where somebody tells you that moving is good for you.

Here is what is actually different this year.

Up to now, a task arrived and you did it. The teacher set the distance, the teacher set the apparatus, and the teacher decided when it was hard enough. **This year you start setting some of that yourself**, and you find out that choosing well is a skill of its own, and a harder one than it looks.

That is why the fields at the top of the hill are the ones you have been walking past since Year 1 without going in.

The gate

Almost every task in this book comes as a **five-bar gate**, and each bar is the same task made harder.

You pick the bar you can hold today. You work on the one above it. And you say which bar you are on, out loud, before you go.

That sounds easy. It is not, and here is why.

WHAT MOST PEOPLE DO	WHAT THIS YEAR ASKS FOR
Pick the bar they already fit on, because it feels good	Pick the bar above it, because that is where anything changes
Pick the top bar, get it wrong, and stop	Pick a bar they can hold for a whole go, and then climb
Say "I did the hard one"	Say "I am on bar 3, and bar 4 fails at the turn"

The third row is the one this book is really about. By the end of Unit 1 you should be able to say, out loud and without being asked, exactly which version of a task you are working on and exactly where it goes wrong.

Four jobs, and you will do all of them

Almost every task needs more than one of you, because you cannot watch yourself move. The first three jobs came up the hill with you from Year 3. The fourth arrived in Year 4 and is the one that makes this subject honest.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO
Mover	Do the movement, properly, as many times as the task says	Rush it to look quick, or quietly change the bar you said you were on
Timer	Count, or time, and say the number out loud	Guess, round the number kindly, or start the watch early
Watcher	Look at one thing only, and say what you saw	Say "good", which tells the mover nothing at all
Setter	Change the ground, or the task, while it is running	Change it to something dangerous, or change it to be funny

Swap jobs every time. The watcher's job is the one most people are worst at, and the setter's job is the one most people enjoy far too much.

And one thing before the jobs

New this year, and it is not a fifth job. It is something that happens **before** anybody moves.

THE DAY SHEET · PINNED TO THE GATEPOST BEFORE ANYBODY MOVES

MINUTES	PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO
0-6	The hill lane	Warm up, walk then jog, twice up	Everybody
6-18	The clay ground	Gate 1.1, four goes each	Pip moves, Bramble times, Willow watches
18-30	The clay ground	Same gate, jobs rotate	Sorrel, Tuft, Rowan
30-35	The wall	Read the notes back, agree the next bar	Everybody

Thirty-five minutes, three places, six of us, and every one of them knows what they are doing before we get through the gate.

A group that writes the morning down looks slower for the first two minutes and then gets roughly twice as much done. A group that does not spends the lesson deciding, and the deciding happens standing still.

You will write one of these at the end of this unit, and it will be marked.

Your year, in three terms

Three terms, and each one finishes with a whole day of it. Those three days are where everything in this book gets used at once, and they are the only days of the year when the whole of Upper Primary is out on the fields together.

They are in the book this early on purpose. **You know the date, so you can work backwards from it.**

TERM 1
16 December 2026

Athletics Day

- Sprint
- Relays
- Standing long jump
- Target throw
- Obstacle race

Five events, and four of them are things you audit in Unit 1.

TERM 2
17 March 2026

Football Day

- Dribbling in and out of the cones
- Passing accuracy game
- Penalty shootout
- Full game

Every one of these needs you to adapt to other bodies, which is Topic 1.4.

TERM 3
17 June 2026

Multi-sports Day

- Bowling
- Sack racing
- Bean bag throw
- Water pong

Four unlike skills in one morning. A broad range, tested.

How the three days connect to this book

THE DAY	WHAT IT ASKS OF YOU	WHERE YOU PRACTISE IT
Athletics Day , 16 Dec	A broad range of separate events, each done well once	1.1 Keeping a broad range in repair
Football Day , 17 Mar	Skills linked under pressure, with other bodies in the way	1.2 A wider variety, linked · 1.4 Adapting live

THE DAY	WHAT IT ASKS OF YOU	WHERE YOU PRACTISE IT
Multi-sports Day, 17 Jun	Four skills that are nothing like each other , in one morning	1.1 the audit · 1.3 Fluency

Look at the middle column. Not one of those three days asks you to be good at one thing. Every one of them asks you to be **in working order across a range**, which is why this book opens with an audit instead of a race.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

There is a reason the dates are printed and not left vague.

A target with a date on it changes how people practise. If Athletics Day is on the sixteenth of December, then a standing long jump that is rusty in September has about fourteen weeks to be repaired, and you can say how many of those weeks you have actually spent on it. A target with no date attached is a wish.

Work backwards from the date. It is the single most useful thing on this page.

Meet the six

The same six as always, three years older, and every one of them has a different problem this year.



Walking up to the gate together. Between them they are carrying the hoop, a rope and the ball, which is most of the kit list. Willow is the one flying, and she has brought nothing, because Willow is going to be watching.

Pip

Red squirrel, cream vest. Quick, and still the first to try anything. Last year he learned that his fastest attempt is not his best attempt. This year he has to learn something harder: that climbing to a bar he already fits on is not practice, it is a warm up.

Bramble

Badger, slate vest with cream trim. Strong and steady, and he never rushes. He holds the stopwatch and he reads out the number that is actually on it. This year he plans a morning and finds out he has written one only he could finish.

Sorrel

Brown hare, olive vest. The fastest of all of them, which mattered enormously in Year 3 and matters less every year since. This year she finds out that a Year 6 sequence is judged on fluency, and that being quick is not the same as being fluent.

Tuft

Hedgehog, rust vest. The smallest and the most careful. He reads a space before he moves into it, which is why he is almost never in anybody's way. This year he has to work on the things he has quietly stopped doing, not the ones he already feels safe at.



Willow

Barn owl. She watches, from the top of the gatepost where she can see the whole shape of a movement. She is the reason this book keeps asking you to say what you saw instead of saying whether you liked it.

This year her job grows. It is no longer enough to describe a movement accurately: she has to turn what she saw into a **success criterion**, a sentence somebody else could use to judge the same movement without her there. When you see her notes in a slate-grey panel, read *how* she says it, not only what she says.

Rowan

Otter, hedge-green vest. Happiest in a group and very good at giving everybody a job. This year he has to write the plan down so that it works when he is not standing there explaining it, and then take the least popular job himself.

None of the six is better than the others. Each one is good at a different thing, which is exactly how a class works, and it is why the tasks keep making you swap.

How to use this book

Every place on the high fields is built the same way, so once you know the shapes you always know where you are.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Before you go up	A question to talk about before you move. There is no wrong answer yet.
What happened	The real problem for this topic. Everything after it is you sorting that out.
On these fields you will	What you will be able to do by the end. Come back and check.
Warm up	Two minutes, straight in, and it is never optional in this subject.
Do you remember?	Something from an earlier topic or an earlier year that you are about to need again.
Learn	The gate and the new idea. Read the drawing first, then the words.
Watch me try	One attempt, taken slowly, with the reason for each part.
Try it another way	A second route to the same thing. Year 6 wants variety, not one method.
Your turn	Your work. Move first, then write, draw and tick in the book.
Willow's own notes	What a watcher actually wrote, and the criterion she turned it into.
Stay safe	Violet. An instruction, not a suggestion. Read it before you move.
The equipment you need	Fetch this before you start, so nobody stands about.
Did you know?	A true thing worth knowing that is not in any test.
Go a little further	For when you have finished and want more.
Climb a bar	Harder, on purpose. Expect to need three attempts.
The day you plan	The project at the end of the unit. You plan the morning, then you run it.
How did it go?	You judging your own work, honestly.
Look what I can do	The tick list. Only tick what is true today.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
-------	---------------

Words we used Every new word, with its meaning.

The gates

Wherever you see a **five-bar gate** in the place colour, you are looking at one task written four or five times over, each bar harder than the bar below it.

- **Ring the bar you can hold today.** Not the one you managed once.
- **The bar above it is your work.** Write down where it goes wrong.
- **Nobody is on the same bar, and nobody needs to be.** Two of you on bar 2 and bar 4 of the same gate are doing the same lesson.

The other two drawings

DRAWING	WHAT IT SHOWS
---------	---------------

A day sheet A morning laid out in minutes: which place, what happens there, and who is doing it.

A marked ground The swept clay ground seen from above, with white chalk on it, the way Willow sees it.

The chalk marks mean the same thing everywhere in the book, and they are the same marks you have been reading since Year 3.

MARK	MEANS
a solid white line	a line you may not cross
a dashed white line	the route a body travels
a white ring	where a body starts, or stops
a small cross	a cone, a marker or a spot
a dark disc	a body, at one moment
the ticks down the left edge	paces, counted

Writing in this book

You are meant to. The pale boxes, the ruled lines and the timing tables are yours. Use a pencil, because your second attempt is usually a different number from your first, and that is the whole point.

The square codes

Two pages carry a small square code. Each one opens a free page that gives you something this book cannot: a national guideline in its own words, and a real set of race results. **An adult holds the device and opens the page.** There is nothing in this book you cannot finish without one.

Getting set up

You do not need everything at once. Each place tells you what to fetch.

Your kit for the high fields

- soft indoor shoes, or bare feet, whichever your teacher says for the space
- a stopwatch, or one clock everybody can see
- six cones, or six of anything that stands up and does not roll away
- two skipping ropes
- a hoop
- one ball that bounces
- chalk, or a roll of low-tack tape, for marking a line on the ground
- a clipboard and a pencil, because a watcher who has to remember is a watcher who invents
- five other people, which is still the most important item on the list



Your kit, laid out. Not one thing here needs a screen. Count them against the list above: shoes, a stopwatch, six cones, two ropes, a hoop, a ball, a stub of chalk, a clipboard and a pencil. The clipboard does more work in Year 6 than it has ever done.

Ground rules

- 1 Walk up to the gate. Everybody walks, every time, however exciting it is.
- 2 Look before you move, and look again if somebody has changed the ground.
- 3 One mover at a time on a piece of apparatus, unless the task says otherwise.
- 4 The timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind.
- 5 A watcher says what they **saw**, never whether it was good.
- 6 A setter changes the task, never the safety. If a change would make a task dangerous, the setter does not make it.
- 7 Say which bar you are on, out loud, before you go. Changing it quietly halfway through is the one thing in this book that counts as cheating.
- 8 Put the equipment back where it came from, at the end, without being asked.
- 9 Stop the moment you hear "stop". Not after this one. Now.
- 10 An adult holds the device for any square code.

+ STAY SAFE

Before anybody moves, check four things and say them out loud:

The ground. Dry, clear, nothing to trip on, nothing to slide on. **The edges.**

Nothing hard within two paces of any line you might run past, and nobody working close to the wall. **The gate and the apparatus.** Every gate, bench, box and mat checked and tested by an adult, not by you. A gate is for climbing only when an adult says it is. **The plan.** Everybody knows which place they are going to and what happens there.

If any of the four is wrong, you tell an adult and you do not begin.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Rule 7 is new this year, and it is worth knowing why it is in the list at all.

A gate only works if the bar is honest. A pupil who says "bar 4" and quietly does bar 2 has not gained anything: they have thrown away the one piece of information the whole method depends on, which is where their limit actually is. Nobody can help you at a level you are pretending to be on.

Saying "I am on bar 2" out loud, in front of five other people, is genuinely harder than doing bar 4 badly. That is why it is a rule and not a suggestion.



The high fields, all six places. The gate you come in by, the swept clay ground just inside it, the hay meadow, the orchard, the tack room and the spring. One unit happens at each of them, and this book is the first one.

UNIT 1 · THE FIVE-BAR GATE

1

Moving well

You have a repertoire now. This unit is about keeping all of it in working order, linking pieces of it that are not alike, and holding a task you chose yourself while somebody else changes the ground under you.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① audit a broad range of your own skills, then repair the rustiest one rather than the favourite
- ② link four movements from three different families into one short sequence
- ③ say what separates **smooth** from **fluent**, and be judged on both
- ④ choose your own task and hold it while a setter and a second mover change the ground

△ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Name three things your body does well.

Now name the one it used to do well and has not done since about February.

Almost everybody has one. A skill you were good at, stopped using, and quietly lost. Nothing dramatic happened to it: you simply stopped spending time on it, and a skill you do not spend time on goes rusty in a way that is very hard to notice from the inside.

This unit starts there, because **consolidating a broad range** means keeping all of it in working order, and that is a completely different job from getting better at your best thing.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Keeping a broad range in repair

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Two cones, chalk or tape for one line, a stopwatch or a wall clock, one clipboard and a pencil. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Walk briskly anywhere on the clay ground for one minute, changing direction whenever you meet somebody, without touching anybody. Then, on the spot: ten shoulder circles backwards, ten ankle rises, and five slow squats to about halfway down.

Now stand still. Your body is warm, your ankles and knees are awake, and you are ready. Cold practice is wasted practice, and at this age it is also how people hurt themselves.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Getting set up, what does rule 7 ask you to do before you go?

And what does it call changing your bar quietly halfway through?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is asked to spend twelve minutes practising.

He spends all twelve on his standing jump, which is already the best thing he does. By the end of it his standing jump is very slightly better and he is very pleased with himself.

Willow, who has been up on the gatepost with the clipboard, asks him to hop five times on his left foot. He wobbles on the second one and puts his other foot down on the fourth.

"When did you last do that?" she asks.

Pip cannot remember. That is the answer.

► Learn

You do not have one skill. You have a **repertoire**: a whole set of movements you can already perform, built up over six years.

A repertoire behaves like anything else you own. The parts you use stay in working order. The parts you stop using go rusty, and they go rusty silently, because nothing warns you about a skill you are not practising.

So Year 6 asks for a different kind of practice from Year 3. Not *refine my best movement*. **Keep a broad range in repair.**

Which means, before anything else, finding out what state the range is actually in. That is called an **audit**, and it takes one lesson.

A SKILL FAMILY	MOVEMENTS IN IT
Travelling	run, jog, skip, gallop, side-step, change direction
Leaving the ground	two-footed jump, hop, leap, land, take off from one foot
Turning	turn on the spot, turn while travelling, roll, spin
Balancing	hold still on a small base, on one foot, on a bench, on tiptoe
Sending and receiving	throw, catch, bounce, kick, strike, stop a ball

Five families. Almost everything you have learned since Year 1 sits in one of them, and most people have one family that has quietly stopped being practised.

The rule for this topic is short. Audit the range. Repair the rustiest. Leave your favourite alone for one lesson, because it does not need you.

GATE 1.1 · THE REPAIR GATE

- ① Practise your rustiest skill on your own. Ten goes. Nobody watching.
- ② Ten goes with a watcher looking at **one** named detail.
- ③ Ten goes, and you name the detail **before** you start, and it does not change once.
- ④ Ten goes, alternating with a **second** rusty skill, so neither one gets to stay warm.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and the timer records both, so you can see which of the two holds up under swapping.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it. Say which one out loud before you go.

Bar 4 is where most of this class will end up, and it is worth saying why it is harder than bar 3 rather than just longer. Alternating two skills stops your body settling into either

one. That is uncomfortable, and it is also much closer to what a game or a gymnastics sequence actually demands of you.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip does the audit properly. Willow holds the clipboard and they go through the five families, four goes at each movement.

FAMILY	MOVEMENT TRIED	WHAT WILLOW WROTE	STATE
travel	side-step, both ways	even both ways, feet never crossed	good
ground	two-footed jump and land	knees bent, hands still, no wobble	good
ground	hop, left foot, five times	wobbled on 2, other foot down on 4	rusty
turn	turn while travelling	slowed almost to a stop to turn	rusty
balance	one foot, count of ten	held it, arms working hard	nearly
send	bounce and catch, ten	ten from ten, no reaching	good

Pip has two rusty items and one nearly. He picks the **hop on his left foot**, because it failed earliest, and he names his one detail before he begins: *land on the front of the foot with the knee soft, and keep the other foot off the ground.*

Ten goes, Willow watching the raised foot and nothing else, Bramble counting the touch-downs.

GO	RAISED FOOT	TOUCH-DOWNS	WHAT PIP CHANGED NEXT
1	down on hop 4	2	nothing yet, that was the first one
3	down on hop 4	2	softer knee on landing
5	down on hop 5	1	keep the softer knee, look ahead
8	stayed up	0	nothing. Do that again.
10	stayed up	0	nothing. It is repaired, for today.

Notice the last column at goes 8 and 10. When something works you do **not** change it. You repeat it until it is the thing your body does without being asked.

And notice what Pip did not do. He did not spend the lesson on his standing jump, which was already good, and he did not try to fix the hop and the turn in the same twelve minutes.

◇ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Hop, left foot, go 1: other foot came down on hop 4, landing on the heel, knee locked straight.

Hop, left foot, go 10: other foot stayed up for all five, landing on the front of the foot, knee giving a little each time.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

the raised foot must not touch the ground, and each landing must be on the front of the foot with a visible bend in the knee.

That last line is new this year. It is not enough to describe what you saw accurately. Willow has turned her description into a **success criterion**: a sentence another pupil could use to judge the same hop, tomorrow, without her there. Unit 2 is built on that sentence, and it starts here.



The same hop, again and again, on purpose. The faint shapes behind Pip are his earlier goes: this is one skill being repaired, not six skills being sampled. Look at Willow, low down and very close in. She is watching the raised foot and nothing else, which is the one detail Pip named before he started.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

Naide Gomes competed for Portugal in two very different jobs.

In 2004 she won the world indoor **pentathlon** title in Budapest with 4,759 points. A pentathlon is five events in one competition: she had to hurdle, jump high, put a shot, jump long and run 800 metres, all in the same day, all to a decent standard.

A knee injury in 2005 ended her combined events career. From 2006 she was a long jumper and nothing else, and in 2008 she won the world indoor **long jump** title in Valencia with 7.00 metres. Her best ever jump, 7.12 metres in Monaco on 29 July 2008, is still the Portuguese record.

Read those two paragraphs together. She spent years keeping five events in working order at once, and then spent years refining one. Both are real training. This topic is the first job, and Year 3 was mostly the second.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Audit your range.** Four goes at one movement from each family. Your watcher writes what they saw. You write good, nearly, or rusty.

FAMILY	MOVEMENT I TRIED	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	STATE
travel	_____	_____	_____
ground	_____	_____	_____
turn	_____	_____	_____
balance	_____	_____	_____
send	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Which one failed **earliest**?** That is your rustiest, and it is not necessarily the one that felt worst.

My rustiest skill is

- 3 Name your one detail before you start. It must be about a body part, and a watcher must be able to see it.

The one detail I will change is

- 4 Ten goes. Fill this in as you go.

GO	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	COUNT
1	_____	_____
4	_____	_____
7	_____	_____
10	_____	_____

- 5 Which bar of the repair gate were you on? Ring one, and be honest: this is rule 7.

- ☐ Bar 1, on my own
- ☐ Bar 2, with a watcher
- ☐ Bar 3, detail named first and never changed
- ☐ Bar 4, two skills alternating
- ☐ Bar 5, two skills alternating and both timed

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap and run the whole audit on your watcher's range.

Then answer this out loud: were their rusty families the same as yours? In most classes they are not, and the reason is worth a minute of talking. People keep practising what they enjoy, and the family you have let go rusty is usually the family you were never especially good at.

☰ SCAN TO FIND OUT MORE · TWENTY-FOUR ONE-MINUTE CHALLENGES



Twenty-four **one-minute challenges** from the Youth Sport Trust, free to download, with a bronze, silver and gold target on each one and a sheet to write your scores on. Speed bounce, target throw, balance, skipping and plenty more.

Why it is here. Every challenge is built the way this topic is: you do it for sixty seconds, you write the number down, and the only score you are trying to beat is **your own last one**. Pick one from a family you have let go rusty and take it home.

AN ADULT OPENS THIS PAGE

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

A wider variety, linked

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for two lines, six cones, one low wooden bar and one mat if your space has them. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Cross the clay ground and back four times, using a different skill family each time: travel, leave the ground, turn, balance. Any movement from the family will do, as long as it is a different family every crossing.

That is the warm up and it is also the point of this topic. Four families in one minute is easy. Four families joined together, with no stop, is what the rest of the page is about.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.1, name the five skill families.

♦ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel builds a sequence: run, sprint, run fast round a cone, sprint again.

"Four movements," she says. "No stops anywhere."

Willow looks at her clipboard. "Four movements from one family," she says. "You have built a sequence out of running."

Sorrel starts to argue and then stops, because she knows Willow is right.

► Learn

In Year 3 a sequence meant **three movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle**, and the joins were the work.

Year 6 keeps all of that and adds one word. The scheme asks you to link a **wider variety** of movement skills. So a sequence is now judged on two separate things:

JUDGED ON	WHICH MEANS
The joins	Still. No stop, no extra step, no arm shooting out to save it.
The variety	How many different families the movements come from.

Sorrel's sequence has excellent joins and no variety at all. It scores well on one of the two and nothing on the other.

And there is a reason variety is harder than length. **The joins between unlike movements are genuinely more difficult**, because the end of a run and the start of a balance want completely different things from your body: a run wants speed, and a balance wants none. Joining a run to a sprint is easy because nothing has to change. Joining a run to a balance is the actual skill.

GATE 1.2 · THE LINKING GATE

- ① Two movements, **one** family, one join.
- ② Three movements, at least **two** families, two joins.
- ③ Four movements, at least **three** families, three joins.
- ④ As bar 3, and the sequence **finishes in a balance** you can hold to a count of three.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you perform the whole thing **twice**, and a watcher cannot tell the two goes apart.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it. Bar 5 is Year 6 work, not a bonus.

► WATCH ME TRY

Sorrel rebuilds her sequence, and this time she picks families first and movements second.

Families chosen: travelling, leaving the ground, balancing. Three. **Movements:** run, leap from one foot, land, balance on one foot.

Attempt 1. She runs, leaps, lands, and puts her second foot straight down to steady herself. *Join 3 failed. The balance never happened.*

Attempt 2. She shortens the run so she arrives at the leap slower, lands with a deeper knee bend, and gets into the balance. She holds it for about one second and steps out of it. *Join 3 worked. The balance is not yet a balance.*

Attempt 3. Same run, same leap, and she lands with her arms already out sideways instead of bringing them out afterwards. *Three joins, and a balance held past three.*

Read attempt 2 again, because it is the useful one. **Slowing the run down made the whole sequence better.** Sorrel has spent three years learning that faster is

better, and this is the first task that has ever paid her for going slower.

⇌ TRY IT ANOTHER WAY

There is a second route to bar 4, and some bodies find it much easier.

Instead of *run, leap, land, balance*, try *run, turn, slow, balance*: keep the travelling and the balance, and replace leaving the ground with turning. It is still three families, still four movements, still three joins.

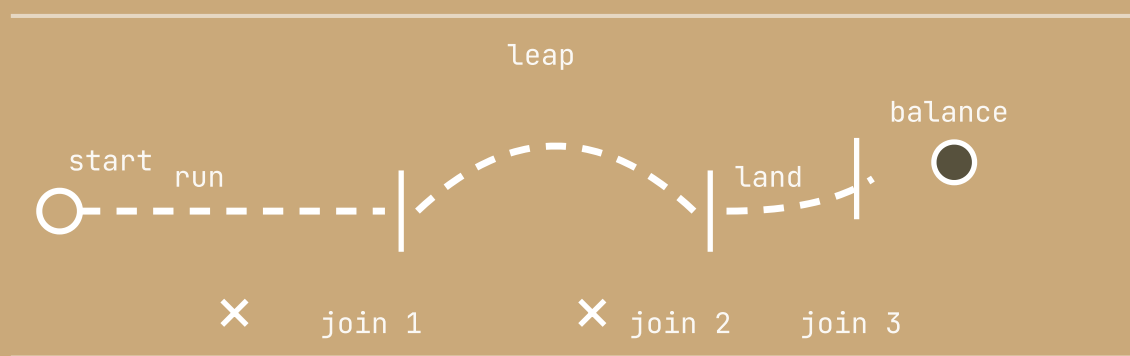
Why it can be easier: a turn lets you lose speed **gradually**, over a curve, whereas a leap gives you all your speed back at the moment you land and asks you to absorb it in one knee bend.

Do both. Then say which one your body prefers and why. Year 6 wants you to have more than one answer, not the right one.



The second route, and no leap in it. Read Sorrel left to right: a run, then one long banked curve round the cones, then a still balance. She loses her speed gradually all the way round the turn instead of taking it back in one knee bend. Same four movements, same three joins, and a completely different feel.

MARKED GROUND 1.2 · FOUR MOVEMENTS, THREE JOINS



The clay ground from above, chalked. The three short upright marks are the joins, and the only one that is genuinely difficult is join 3, where a body that is still travelling has to become a body that is completely still. The filled disc is the held balance. The two crosses are cones.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

A triathlon is three unlike movements in a row: at the standard Olympic distance, a 1.5 kilometre swim, a 40 kilometre ride and a 10 kilometre run.

The interesting part is how it is timed. A triathlon is timed in **five** sections, not three. Between the swim and the ride there is T1, and between the ride and the run there is T2, and World Triathlon publishes each of those as its own column in the results. As the rules put it, the time spent in transition is a timed segment and it counts towards the overall finishing time.

So the sport has decided, officially, that **the join is part of the event**. Two athletes can swim, ride and run at exactly the same speed, and the one who is better at the two joins wins.



Four movements, one continuous line. Read Sorrel left to right: the run is still going, the leap has already left the ground, and the last shape is arriving on one foot. Nothing in this picture has stopped, and nothing has put a second foot down to steady itself. Willow is on the gatepost, watching the joins rather than the movements.

• YOUR TURN

1 Choose your families first. Tick the ones your sequence will use. Bar 3 needs at least three ticks.

- ☐ travelling
- ☐ leaving the ground
- ☐ turning
- ☐ balancing
- ☐ sending and receiving

2 Now choose the movements, in order.

OUR SEQUENCE

1

2

3

4

Three joins. Mark each one with an arrow, and write the family beside each movement.

- 3 Run it three times. After each go the watcher names the **weakest join**, not the whole sequence.

GO	THE WEAKEST JOIN WAS	BECAUSE
1		
2		
3		

- 4 Chalk your sequence on the ground below, seen from above. Use a dashed line for the route, a ring for the start, a dark disc for a held position, and a short upright mark at each join.

OUR SEQUENCE, CHALKED FROM ABOVE

- 5 Tick every one that is true of your third go.
- ☐ Four movements, from at least three families.
 - ☐ No stop and no extra step at any join.
 - ☐ It finished in a balance I held to a count of three.
 - ☐ I could have performed it again immediately, the same way.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Perform your sequence twice, back to back, and ask a watcher who has not seen it before to write down **both** goes separately.

You pass when they cannot tell you which description belongs to which go.

If they can tell, do not explain. Find the movement where the two goes differed and practise that one, on its own, ten times.

≡ SCAN TO FIND OUT MORE · FIFTY MOVEMENTS, DEMONSTRATED



More than fifty activity cards from the Youth Sport Trust, free and with nothing to join, and **a short video of somebody doing each one**. Travelling, jumping, turning, balancing, throwing and catching: every family in this topic is in there.

Why it is here. You cannot link movements you have not got. Watch three you have never tried, learn one of them, and put it into your sequence next lesson. That is one more family, which is a whole bar on the gate.

AN ADULT OPENS THIS PAGE

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Fluency, and how it is judged

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for two lines, six cones, a drum or a tambourine if your teacher has one, a stopwatch and a clipboard. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Cross the clay ground four times on your teacher's signal: once as fast as you safely can, once as slowly as you possibly can, once as tall as you can, and once as low as you can.

Then do it a fifth time and try to keep the **same rhythm** all the way across, at any speed you like. That fifth one is what this topic is about, and it is the one almost nobody gets right first time.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.2, a Year 6 sequence is judged on two separate things. Name both.

Which of the two did Sorrel score nothing on?

♦ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft performs his sequence. There are no stops in it anywhere. He gets to the end and looks quietly pleased.

"Smooth," says Pip.

"Not fluent," says Willow, and she reads back what she wrote. "Run, then a pause that was not quite a stop, then a very fast turn, then a slow careful balance. Four different speeds in one sequence and none of them chosen."

► Learn

Year 3 asked for **smooth**: no wasted wobble, no extra step, no arm shooting out to save it. You can hear that it is about the joins.

Year 6 asks for **fluent**, and it is a different word doing a different job.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	WHERE YOU LOOK
Smooth	Nothing goes wrong at the joins	At each join
Fluent	The whole thing has one rhythm, and it was chosen	At the whole sequence
Variety	The parts are genuinely different from each other	At the list of families

A sequence can be perfectly smooth and not fluent at all, which is exactly what Tuft's was. Every join worked. The rhythm changed four times, by accident.

So fluency is about the parts you are **not** looking at. It is the speed you hold between the joins, and it is the reason a performance can be technically correct and still look like four separate things stapled together.

The rule for this topic. Smooth is about the joins. Fluent is about the whole. Choose the rhythm before you start, and hold it.

GATE 1.3 · THE FLUENCY GATE

- ① Perform your 1.2 sequence with no stops.
- ② No stops, and no extra steps between movements.
- ③ No stops, no extra steps, and **one rhythm** held from start to finish.
- ④ Perform it twice at that rhythm, and a watcher cannot tell the goes apart.
- ⑤ Perform it once fast and once slow, **both** fluent, and still recognisably the same sequence.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is the one that separates fluency from speed.

► WATCH ME TRY

Tuft does it again, and this time he chooses the rhythm before he moves.

"Slow," he says. "All of it. Count of four for every movement."

Bramble times each movement separately, which is the only way to see a rhythm.

GO	RUN	TURN	LEAP	BALANCE	WHAT WILLOW WROTE
1	3 s	1 s	1 s	5 s	four different speeds, not chosen
2	4 s	2 s	1 s	4 s	better, the leap still bolts
3	4 s	3 s	2 s	4 s	one rhythm, held all the way

Look at the leap column. It went from 1 second to 2 seconds, and that is the whole repair. A leap is the movement that most wants to be fast, so it is the movement that breaks a slow rhythm, and Tuft fixed it by taking a shorter run into it.

Now look at go 1 again. Nobody would have called that sequence badly performed. It had no stops in it. It was smooth, and it was not fluent, and until somebody timed each movement separately nobody could say why.

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 1: run quick, turn snatched, leap fast, balance long and careful. Four speeds.

Go 3: run, turn, leap and balance all took about the same time. One speed the whole way. Arms moved at that speed too.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

time each movement separately. In a fluent sequence no movement takes less than half as long as the longest one.

That is a criterion you can hand to somebody with a stopwatch who has never seen the sequence, and they can apply it without you. Turning what you saw into a rule somebody else can use is the whole of Unit 2, and Willow is two topics early.



One crossing, three ways. The same chalk line and the same two cones run under all three. On the left Tuft goes fast and low. In the middle Sorrel goes slowly and very tall. On the right Bramble goes small and strong. Look at how much the shape of the body changes while the route does not change at all.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

Artistic gymnastics scores a routine with two numbers, and they measure exactly the two things this topic separates.

The **D score** is difficulty. It adds up the hardest elements, and it pays a bonus called **Composition Requirements** for using skills from the required element groups, worth 0.5 each up to 2.00. It pays a second bonus, **Connection Value**, for linking elements together. In other words, the D score pays for **variety** and for **joins**, which is Topic 1.2.

The **E score** is execution, and it works the other way round. Every routine starts at **10.0**, and judges take deductions off: 0.1 for a small error, 0.3 for a medium one, 0.5 for a large one, and 1.0 for a fall. Pausing between skills that were meant to be connected loses connection value.

So a gymnast is paid for variety and linking, and charged for everything that is not fluent. That is not a coincidence. It is the same judgement this unit is teaching you to make.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your 1.2 sequence and have your timer time **each movement separately**. Do not choose a rhythm yet.

MOVEMENT	GO 1	GO 2	GO 3
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____
4	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Look down the Go 1 column. Which movement is the **shortest**? That is the one breaking your rhythm.

Movement _____ is breaking it.

- 3 Now choose a rhythm out loud, before you move, and perform it again. Write the rhythm you chose.

The rhythm I chose is _____

- 4 Apply Willow's criterion to your Go 3 column. In a fluent sequence, no movement takes less than **half** as long as the longest one. Does yours pass?

- ☐ Yes, every movement is at least half the longest.
- ☐ No, and the movement that fails is number _____

- 5 Score your own Go 3 the way gymnastics does, and be strict with yourself.

TAKE OFF	FOR	YOUR DEDUCTIONS
0.1	a small wobble, an arm that moved to help	_____
0.3	an extra step, a rhythm that changed once	_____
0.5	a clear pause where there should be a join	_____
1.0	a fall, or a foot put down in a balance	_____

Start at 10.0, take your deductions off, and write what is left.

My execution score is _____

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Perform your sequence at a rhythm your watcher chooses and does not tell you until you are on the start line.

This is much harder than choosing your own, and it is worth knowing why: you have practised your sequence at one speed, so all the small adjustments you have learned belong to that speed. A rhythm you did not choose takes those adjustments away.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Choosing your own task, and adapting live

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Six cones, one low bar, one mat, a stopwatch and a clipboard. If your space has a slope or a flight of low steps, and an adult has checked it, use it. **A teacher sets out and tests every piece of apparatus before the lesson begins.**

+ STAY SAFE

This topic puts two movers in one space and lets a third pupil change the task while they are moving. That is the point of it, and it is also the reason these four rules are not negotiable.

- 1 An adult sets out and tests every bar, box, mat and step. You never move apparatus into place yourself, and never while somebody is using it.
- 2 **The setter may change the task. The setter may never change the safety.** No change may send a mover into another body, off an edge, into the wall, or onto apparatus that was not set out for it.
- 3 Two movers share a space only when both of them have said out loud that they know the other one is there.
- 4 Any wobble at all in a bar, a box or a step: stop, step off, tell an adult. Do not test it again to see whether it does it twice.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.3, what is the difference between smooth and fluent?

Smooth is about _____ . Fluent is about _____ .

♦ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan has a sequence he is proud of, performed at a rhythm he chose, fluent from start to finish. He has practised it for two lessons on his own patch of clay.

Pip is made setter. Halfway through Rowan's run, Pip moves a cone into his line.

Rowan stops, thinks, goes round the outside of the cone, loses the leap completely, and arrives at the balance facing the wrong way.

"That was not fair," says Rowan.

"That was a lesson," says Willow, who is writing it down.

► Learn

Everything so far in this unit has happened in conditions you controlled. Your space, your rhythm, your sequence, nobody in the way.

Objective 1.4 asks for something else, and it asks for it in one long sentence worth reading slowly: apply movement competence with confidence in a variety of **self-selected** and more structured physical activities, showing the ability to respond and **adapt to changing contexts and to other people's movements, responses and roles**.

Two halves, and both are new.

The first half is that you choose. Nobody sets your task any more. You pick your bar off the gate, and the choosing is now part of the work. Choose too low and nothing happens. Choose too high and you spend the lesson failing at bar 5 instead of improving at bar 3.

The second half is that the conditions do not hold still. A setter changes the ground while you are working. Another mover shares your space and does not care about your plan. In a real game, both of those happen every few seconds.

WHEN THE GROUND CHANGES**KEEP****CHANGE**

A setter changes the dynamic

the movements, the order, the joins

the speed, the level, the size, the force

WHEN THE GROUND CHANGES	KEEP	CHANGE
A setter moves a marker	the movements, the rhythm	the direction, the pathway, where you finish
Another mover takes your space	the sequence, the rhythm	your line, your timing, which side you pass

Read the **Keep** column again. Rowan lost his leap because he treated a moved cone as a new task instead of as one dial turned on the task he already had.

The rule for this topic. Keep the sequence. Change the one thing you were asked to change. Everything else stays exactly where it was.

GATE 1.4 · THE LIVE GATE

- ① You choose the sequence and perform it alone, on your own patch of clay.
- ② You choose it, and a setter changes **one dynamic** halfway through.
- ③ You choose it, and a setter **moves a marker** into your route halfway through.
- ④ You choose it, and a **second mover** shares the ground, so you adapt to a body, not a word.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and the setter changes the task for **both** movers at the same time.

You choose the bar. That is the whole point of this gate. Say which one out loud, and do not change it quietly.

► WATCH ME TRY

Rowan goes again, and this time he knows what adapting means.

Attempt 1. Pip moves a cone into the run. Rowan takes the run wider, keeps going, takes the leap from a little further out, and gets to the balance. *The leap*

was small and the balance wobbled, but the sequence survived. Nothing was abandoned.

Attempt 2. Pip moves the cone earlier. Rowan takes the wider line and arrives late at the balance. *The sequence survived. The rhythm did not: the last two movements were rushed to catch up.*

Attempt 3. Pip moves the cone earlier again. This time Rowan takes the wider line **and slows the run before it**, so he arrives at the leap with time to spare. *The sequence survived and so did the rhythm.*

Attempt 3 is the whole topic in one line. Rowan did not react faster. He **anticipated the cost** of the change and paid for it earlier in the sequence, which is what a Year 6 pupil can do and a Year 3 pupil cannot.



The setter, the mover and the body already on the path. Rowan is on the right with one arm up: he has just set a change. Sorrel is mid-stride on the path and has not stopped. Now look at the cone down by Tuft: that is the marker that moved, and Tuft is standing next to it, which means the change Sorrel actually has to make is not only the one that was set.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

Futsal is the version of football that is played indoors, and it is built to force exactly the adaptation this topic is about.

Five players a side on court, one of them the goalkeeper. A pitch of 40 metres by 20, which is small. Two periods of 20 minutes, and the clock **stops** at every dead ball, so almost all of the 40 minutes is played. And substitutions are unlimited and may be made **while the ball is in play**: a player comes off and another comes straight on without the game pausing.

Think about what that last rule does. The set of people you are playing with can change while you are in the middle of a movement, and nobody stops to tell you.

Portugal won the FIFA Futsal World Cup in Lithuania in 2021, beating Argentina by 2 goals to 1 in the final. It was Portugal's first title in the competition.

● YOUR TURN

1 You choose. Ring your bar on the live gate, and write it here before you move.

I am working on bar _____

- 2 Perform your sequence three times with a setter. The setter writes what they changed; you write what you kept and what you changed.

GO	WHAT THE SETTER CHANGED	WHAT I KEPT	WHAT I CHANGED
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____

- 3 Look at your **What I kept** column. If it is empty on any row, you started again instead of adapting. Write what you should have kept on that go.

- 4 Now add a second mover and run it twice more. Chalk the two routes on the grounds below: your line solid, theirs dashed, and a cross where you had to give way.

GO 1, TWO MOVERS, FROM ABOVE	GO 2, AFTER WE HAD TALKED ABOUT IT
------------------------------	------------------------------------

- 5 Tick every one that is true of your last go.
- ☐ I kept the movements and the order.
 - ☐ I changed only the thing that was set.
 - ☐ I paid for the change earlier in the sequence instead of at the end.
 - ☐ The other mover and I never had to stop for each other.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Swap gates with another three, and perform **their** bar 4 rather than your own, from their written sequence only, with their setter setting.

Then tell them the one thing you had to change to make their sequence work on your body. It will not be the thing they change, and that is the interesting part: two bodies adapt the same sequence differently, and neither of them is doing it wrong.

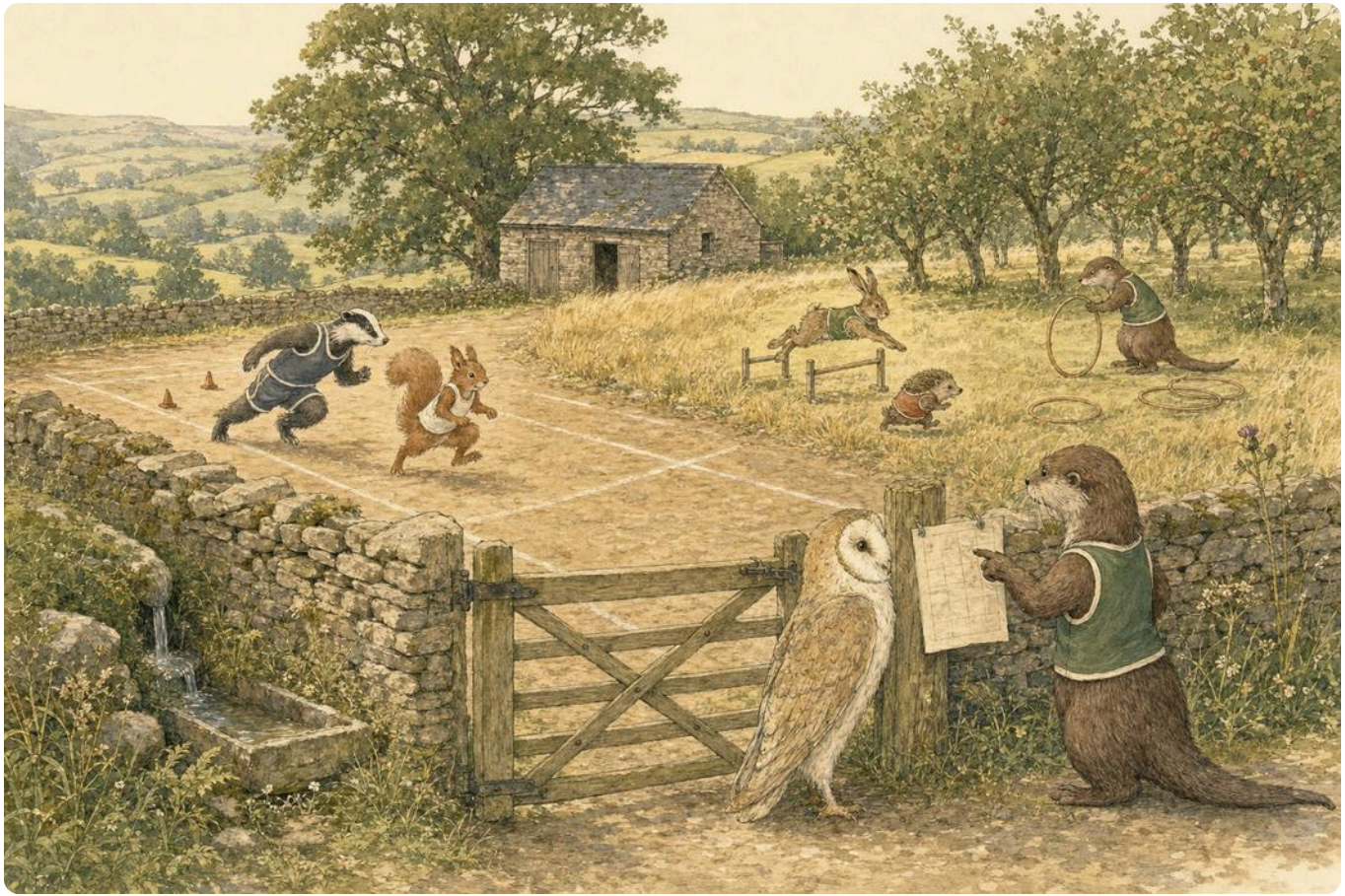
The day you plan

Six of you, three places, thirty-five minutes, and this time nobody sets it up for you.

This is everything from the Five-Bar Gate at once. You will audit a range, build a sequence with real variety in it, make it fluent, choose your own bar, and hold all of it while somebody changes the ground. The difference is that **you write the morning down first, and the plan is marked as well as the moving.**



Before anybody moves. Six of them round one sheet of paper on the gatepost, and not one of them is warming up yet. Rowan is pointing at the row he is not happy with. The kit is already stacked and waiting, which is what a plan buys you.



A morning the six planned themselves. Willow and Rowan are at the day sheet pinned to the gatepost, which is where this project starts and where most of the marks are. Around them, three parts of the high fields are in use at once and nobody is standing about waiting to be told what to do.

THE DAY YOU PLAN • THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Plan it. Fill in a day sheet: minutes, places, what happens there, who does what. Before anybody moves.	Could a group that has never met you run your morning from this sheet alone?
2	Audit and repair. Everybody names their rustiest family and works on it, at a bar they chose.	Did each person repair a rusty skill rather than polish a good one?
3	Build for variety. Four movements, at least three families, three joins, finishing in a held balance.	Count the families. Three or more, or bar 3 is not done.

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
4	Make it fluent. Choose a rhythm out loud. Timer times each movement separately. Apply the half-as-long criterion.	No movement shorter than half the longest one.
5	Run it live. A setter and a second mover. You keep the sequence and change only what was set.	Is the Keep column full on every go?

What good looks like: your sheet is still on the gatepost at the end of the morning with pencil all over it, and every one of the six can say which bar they were on.

Step 1 is the one that gets skipped, and skipping it is the most expensive mistake in this project. A group that plans on the way up the hill finishes all five steps. A group that plans on the clay finishes three of them and argues through the other two.



The two jobs that do the judging. Bramble has the watch up and his eye on it, and Willow has the clipboard, and both of them are looking at the same movement. Sorrel is the small figure away at the edge. In this picture the watchers are the subject, which is the point of step 4.

Our morning, written down before we move

OUR DAY SHEET

MINUTES	PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO

Every row needs all four boxes filled. A row with no name on it is a row where six of you stand still.

OUR SEQUENCE, CHALKED BEFORE WE MOVED

WHAT THE WATCHER WROTE AFTERWARDS

◇ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Sheet: four rows, all four boxes filled, twelve minutes on the clay ground and only six at the wall, which was wrong because six of us cannot rotate through three jobs in six minutes.

Sequence: run, turn, leap, balance. Three families. Three joins, all clean on the second go.

Fluency: run 4 s, turn 3 s, leap 2 s, balance 4 s. Passes the half-as-long criterion.

Live: setter moved a cone at the turn. Sequence kept, rhythm kept, the leap got noticeably shorter and that was the cost.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

a day sheet passes when every row names a place, a task and a person, and when the minutes on each place are enough for everybody on that row to take every job once.

Read the first line again. Willow marked the **sheet**, not the moving, and she found the mistake in it. That is what this project is for.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.



The end of the morning, up on the wall. Everybody has their own sheet on their knees and nobody is comparing scores with anybody else. This is the part of the lesson that looks like nothing is happening, and it is where most of the learning gets written down.

AT THE FIVE-BAR GATE	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I audited a broad range of my own skills honestly	☐ ☐ ☐
I repaired my rustiest skill instead of polishing my best one	☐ ☐ ☐
My sequence used movements from at least three families	☐ ☐ ☐
I can say what separates smooth from fluent	☐ ☐ ☐
I chose a rhythm out loud and held it all the way through	☐ ☐ ☐
I chose my own bar, said which one, and did not change it quietly	☐ ☐ ☐
When the ground changed I kept the sequence and changed one thing	☐ ☐ ☐
Our day sheet could have been run by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐
As a watcher, I turned what I saw into a criterion somebody else could use	☐ ☐ ☐
As a setter, I changed the task and never the safety	☐ ☐ ☐

The last three rows are worth as much as the seven about moving. In Year 6 the watcher writes criteria, the setter holds a safety line, and whoever plans writes a sheet

somebody else can read. Those are the jobs that make the moving worth anything, and they are the ones this year adds.

▪ **LOOK WHAT I CAN DO**

- ☐ audit a broad range of my own skills across five families, honestly
- ☐ name my rustiest skill and repair it with one named detail at a time
- ☐ build a sequence of four movements from at least three different families
- ☐ hold a balance at the end of a sequence to a count of three
- ☐ say what separates smooth from fluent, and which one my last go failed
- ☐ choose a rhythm before I move, and hold it from start to finish
- ☐ apply the half-as-long criterion to somebody else's sequence
- ☐ choose my own bar off a gate, say which one out loud, and stay on it
- ☐ keep a sequence and change only what a setter changed
- ☐ share a space with a second mover without either of us stopping
- ☐ write a day sheet another group could run without me
- ☐ turn something I watched into a success criterion somebody else can use

Words we used

Eighteen words. You used every one of them at the Five-Bar Gate.



Willow, writing it down. She is the reason this book has a word list at all: every one of these words is a word she needed to say exactly what she had seen. Look at how she holds the clipboard, and how still she is.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
repertoire	The whole set of movements you can already perform. Not one skill: all of them.
audit	Checking every part of your repertoire to find out what state it is actually in.
consolidate	To keep a broad range of skills in working order, rather than improving one of them.
skill family	A group of related movements: travelling, leaving the ground, turning, balancing, sending and receiving.
rusty	A skill you used to do well and have stopped practising. It goes silently, which is the problem.
repair	To bring a rusty skill back, one named detail at a time.
refine	To make a movement you can already do better, in small steps.
sequence	Two or more movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle.
join	The place where one movement becomes the next. Harder when the two movements are unlike.
variety	How many different skill families your movements come from. Judged separately from the joins.
smooth	Nothing goes wrong at the joins. You look at each join to see it.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
fluent	The whole sequence has one rhythm, and the rhythm was chosen. You look at the whole thing to see it.
rhythm	The speed you hold between the joins, and how even it is from start to finish.
success criterion	A sentence somebody else can use to judge a movement without you standing there.
deduction	An amount taken off a score for something that went wrong. Gymnastics starts at 10.0 and takes deductions off.
transition	The join between two unlike parts of an event. In a triathlon it is timed and it counts.
adapt	To keep the sequence and change only the one thing that was asked for.
setter	The pupil whose job is to change the task out loud while it is running, and never the safety.

The four jobs

JOB	IN ONE LINE
mover	Does the movement, properly, at the bar they said they were on.
timer	Counts or times, and says the real number out loud.
watcher	Looks at one thing, says what they saw, then turns it into a criterion.
setter	Changes the task while it is running. Never the safety.

The three drawings

DRAWING	WHAT IT SHOWS
five-bar gate	One task written four or five times over, each bar harder than the bar below. Ring the bar you can hold.
day sheet	A morning in minutes: which place, what happens there, and who is doing it.
marked ground	The swept clay ground seen from above, with white chalk on it, the way Willow sees it.

Answers for Unit 1

Some tasks in this unit have one right answer. Most do not, because a movement task is answered with a body and no two bodies answer it the same way. Where there is no single answer, this page says what a good answer must **contain** instead. Teachers can mark from the right-hand column without having seen the lesson.

One thing to watch for throughout: in Year 6 the pupil chooses the bar, so the mark is for **choosing well and reporting honestly**, not for choosing high. A pupil working at bar 2 and saying so has met the objective better than a pupil failing at bar 5 and claiming it.



Two sheets, side by side. Pip is pointing at a line on Bramble's sheet, not on his own. Comparing what you meant with what a watcher wrote is the last step of every task in this unit, and it is the one that turns a morning of moving into something you can carry into next week.

1.1 Keeping a broad range in repair

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, rule 7	Say which bar you are on, out loud, before you go. The second half: changing it quietly halfway through is what the book calls cheating . Accept "lying" or "dishonest" for the second answer, but the pupil must have understood that it is the reporting, not the difficulty, that is at stake.
Practise 1, audit the five families	Five rows completed, one movement per family, with a watcher's description in the middle column. Descriptions must name body parts and what they did. Reject "fine", "bad" and "quite good", which cannot be checked.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 2, which failed earliest	A named skill. Earliest, not worst-feeling: a pupil who names their least favourite skill rather than the one that broke first has not read the task. Accept a disagreement with the watcher if the pupil gives a reason.
Practise 3, name your one detail	Must be about a body part and visible to a watcher: "land on the front of the foot", "keep the raised knee up", "hands still". Reject "do it better", "concentrate", "try harder".
Practise 4, the table of ten goes	Four rows completed, from goes 1, 4, 7 and 10. The watcher's column must describe the one chosen detail each time, not the whole movement. The count is a number. A count that does not fall is a valid result.
Practise 5, which bar	Any bar may be ringed truthfully. Bar 1 is a real answer. What is not acceptable is a ringed bar that the watcher's notes contradict, and that is worth a conversation rather than a mark.
Go a little further, whose families were rusty	No fixed answer. Look for the observation that people stop practising what they were never best at.

1.2 A wider variety, linked

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the five families	Travelling • leaving the ground • turning • balancing • sending and receiving. All five needed, in any order. Accept "jumping" for leaving the ground and "throwing and catching" for sending and receiving.
Practise 1, tick the families	At least three ticks for bar 3. Check the ticks against the movements in Practise 2: a pupil who ticks three families and then writes four kinds of running has ticked aspirationally.
Practise 2, the four movements in order	Four movements, in performance order, drawn from at least three ticked families, with the family written beside each. Three joins marked.
Practise 3, the weakest join	A named join, 1, 2 or 3, with a reason , for each of the three goes. A pupil who writes the whole sequence again instead of naming the join has not done the task. Look for the weakest join changing across the three goes: fixing one join usually reveals another, and that is progress, not failure.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 4, chalk it from above	Must use the marks correctly: dashed line for the route, ring at the start, dark disc for a held position, short upright mark at each join.
Practise 5, ticks	All four may be true. The fourth, "I could have performed it again immediately", is the strongest evidence, because it means the sequence still had something left at the end.
Climb a bar, two goes told apart	Passed only when a watcher who has not seen it before writes both goes separately and cannot say which description belongs to which.

1.3 Fluency, and how it is judged

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the two things a sequence is judged on	The joins and the variety . Both needed. Sorrel scored nothing on variety : her four movements were all from the travelling family. A pupil who says she scored nothing on the joins has it backwards, and 1.2 is worth revisiting with them.
Practise 1, time each movement separately	A time for every movement, for three goes. The point of the task is the spread of times, so a pupil who records one total for the whole sequence has missed it.
Practise 2, the shortest movement	A movement number. In most classes it is a leap or a jump, because leaving the ground is the movement that most wants to be fast. Accept any answer that matches the pupil's own Go 1 column.
Practise 3, the rhythm you chose	Any rhythm stated before moving, and specific enough to hold: "count of four for every movement", "slow all the way", "one, two, three, hold". Reject "smooth" and "normal", which are not rhythms.
Practise 4, the half-as-long criterion	Applied correctly to their own Go 3 column: no movement shorter than half the longest. A pupil who fails it and names the failing movement has completed the task correctly.
Practise 5, score your own Go 3	Deductions taken from 10.0. Look for strictness : a pupil who scores 9.9 on a go their watcher described as having a clear pause has not applied the 0.5. There is no target score.
Go a little further, a rhythm you did not choose	Expect it to be worse than their chosen rhythm, and expect the pupil to be surprised by how much. The reason is in the topic: practised adjustments belong to the practised speed.

1.4 Choosing your own task, and adapting live

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, smooth and fluent	Smooth is about the joins. Fluent is about the whole sequence, and its rhythm. Both halves needed.
Practise 1, ring your bar	Any step, written before moving. This is the objective's "self-selected" half, and the choosing is the assessed part.
Practise 2, the three-column table	Three rows. Every row needs something in What I kept . The kept column is the whole test: it is what separates adapting from starting again.
Practise 3, an empty kept column	Correct answer names what should have been kept: the movements, the order, the joins, or the rhythm. A pupil who writes "nothing" has understood the question and should be asked it again after another go.
Practise 4, two movers drawn	Two routes on each plan, one solid and one dashed, with a cross where somebody gave way. The second drawing should show fewer crossings than the first: that is the effect of having talked about it.
Practise 5, ticks	The third tick, "I paid for the change earlier in the sequence", is the Year 6 answer and the one to look for. Reacting at the moment of the call is Year 3. Anticipating the cost is Year 6.
Climb a bar, swap gates	Passed when the pupils perform another group's bar 4 from the written sequence alone, with that group's setter, and can name the one detail they personally had to change.

The day you plan

STEP	WHAT A FINISHED PROJECT LOOKS LIKE
1 Plan it	A day sheet with every row complete : minutes, level, task, names. The test is the one printed on the page: could a group who had never met them run it from the board alone? Boards that fail usually fail by giving a level too few minutes for everybody to take every role once.
2 Audit and repair	Each pupil names a rusty family, not a strong one, and works at a step they chose and stated.

STEP	WHAT A FINISHED PROJECT LOOKS LIKE
3 Build for variety	Four movements, three or more families, three joins, and a balance held to a count of three. Count the families: this is the step most often claimed and not met.
4 Make it fluent	A rhythm chosen out loud, each movement timed separately, and the half-as-long criterion applied to their own numbers.
5 Run it live	A setter and a second mover. The Keep column full on every go. A group whose sequence collapsed at every call has done bar 5 honestly and should be marked on the honesty and sent back to bar 4.

Marking the plan. Half of this project is the board, and the board is easier to mark than the moving because it is still there at the end of the lesson. If only one thing is marked, mark that.



The tack room, after. Hoops on their pegs, ropes coiled, cones stacked, the ball in its crate. Ground rule 8 says put the equipment back where it came from without being asked, and this is what that looks like when a group has actually done it.

Sources for Unit 1

Every fact in a *Did you know?* panel was checked against the source named here on 2026-08-11. Nothing in this unit is recalled or estimated. The full working ledger, including what was checked and rejected, is in 05-SOURCES-01.md.

TOPIC	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.1	Naide Gomes won the world indoor pentathlon in Budapest in 2004 with 4,759 points; a knee injury in 2005 ended her combined events career; she won the world indoor long jump in Valencia in 2008 with 7.00 metres; her best jump of 7.12 metres in Monaco on 29 July 2008 is the Portuguese record	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Naide_Gomes
1.2	Olympic-distance triathlon is a 1.5 km swim, a 40 km ride and a 10 km run; the event is timed in five sequential sections; the time spent in transition is a timed segment and contributes towards the overall finishing time	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Triathlon
1.2	World Triathlon publishes T1 and T2 as their own result columns	developers.triathlon.org/reference/program-results
1.3	The gymnastics D score pays Composition Requirements of 0.5 per required element group up to 2.00, and Connection Value for linking elements; the E score starts at 10.0 with deductions of 0.1, 0.3, 0.5 and 1.0 for a fall; a pause between skills meant to be connected loses connection value	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Code_of_Points_(gymnastics)
1.4	Futsal is five a side on court including the goalkeeper, on a 40 by 20 metre pitch, two periods of 20 minutes with the clock stopped at every dead ball, and unlimited substitutions permitted while the ball is in play	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Futsal

TOPIC	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.4	Portugal won the 2021 FIFA Futsal World Cup in Lithuania, beating Argentina by 2 goals to 1, their first title	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2021_FIFA_Futsal_World_Cup

Square code destinations

Both addresses were opened and read on 2026-08-11, and both printed codes were decoded off the image to confirm they resolve to exactly these addresses. Neither needs an account and neither charges.

CODE	DESTINATION	WHAT IS THERE
1.1	nhs.uk/live-well/exercise/physical-activity-guidelines-children-and-young-people/	The National Health Service guideline for ages 5 to 18: at least 60 minutes a day of moderate or vigorous activity across the week, spent on a variety of types and intensities of activity to develop movement skills, muscles and bones.
1.2	events.triathlon.org/wtcs/results	World Triathlon's free public results search for the Championship Series, in which the swim, ride and run each carry a time and so do T1 and T2.

For teachers

What this unit is for

Unit 1 covers the four Year 6 *Moving Well* objectives from PDF/Input/Student Book/Y6 Physical Education - Student Book.xlsx: practising, refining and consolidating a broad range of movement skills (1.1), linking a wider variety of skills in short sequences (1.2), control, fluency and variety (1.3), and applying competence with confidence in self-selected and more structured activities while adapting to changing contexts and to others (1.4).

One thing you should know before you teach it

The Year 6 scheme of work in Input is word for word identical to the Year 5 scheme.

All 29 objectives, all six units, character for character. That was measured off both files on 2026-08-11 and it is recorded in 06-SCHEME-MAP.md with the comparison table.

So this book cannot differentiate from Year 5 on objectives, because there is no difference to work from. It differentiates on **demand, autonomy and variety** instead, and the specific choices are these:

	YEAR 5	YEAR 6, THIS UNIT
What is practised	one movement, refined	a broad range , audited and repaired
Sequence	three movements, two joins	four movements, three families, three joins, held finish
Who sets the task	the book or the teacher	the pupil , from a gate, out loud
Adapting to	apparatus and a setter	a setter and another body , at the same time
Judged on	smoothness	fluency , timed, against a criterion

If your school issues a genuinely different Year 6 scheme, this unit will need rewriting against it, and the place to start is 06-SCHEME-MAP.md.

The pedagogical spine

The unit rests on two moves.

The gate. Every substantial task is written four or five times over, each version harder than the one below. The pupil chooses. This is not differentiation-by-worksheet: it is the scheme's own word, *self-selected*, made into a routine, and it means a class of mixed ability works on one task rather than three.

The four jobs, rotating. Mover, timer, watcher and setter, as in Year 5. The watcher's job grows this year: it is no longer enough to describe a movement accurately, they must turn the description into a success criterion another pupil could apply. That is objective 2.3 in embryo, and it is deliberately started here.

Groups of three are therefore not a suggestion for topics 1.1 to 1.3, and topic 1.4 needs four, because it adds a second mover.



Walking back down at the end of the day. The kit has been shared out differently from the way it came up, which happens by itself when a group has spent a morning taking turns at four jobs. Willow is out in front, still watching.

Timing

Four topics and the project fill about six or seven lessons of 45 minutes for most classes. Topic 1.1 needs a full lesson to itself: the audit takes longer than teachers expect, and cutting it removes the evidence the rest of the unit depends on. Topic 1.3 needs a stopwatch per group and will not work without one, because its entire argument rests on timing each movement separately.

Assessment

Assess from the *Look what I can do* list, the *How did it go?* rings, and the project's day sheet. Not from the times.

Two specific warnings.

- **Do not reward a high bar.** A pupil at bar 2 who says so, works at bar 3 and reports where it fails has met 1.4 better than a pupil failing at bar 5. Rule 7 in *Getting set up* exists to protect that, and it only works if the marking backs it.
- **Mark the plan.** Half of the project is the board, and the board is the part that is still on the floor at the end of the lesson. If you only mark one thing, mark that.

Adaptations

- **Distances, heights, weights and timings are all adjustable.** The objective is control, not size. Shorten the run, lower the apparatus, reduce the count.

- **The gate is the adaptation.** A pupil who needs an easier task takes a lower bar on the same gate, which means they are doing the same lesson as everybody else rather than a different one. That is the whole reason the book is built this way.
- **A pupil who cannot travel** takes the same four families into seated or supported movement: an arm pathway can be fast, slow, high, low, large, small, strong or light, can be linked to a turn of the head or a reach, and can be timed for fluency exactly as a run can. The five families become four; say so rather than pretending otherwise.
- **A pupil who cannot write** dictates the watcher's description and the criterion to a partner, or draws the marked ground instead. The criterion matters; the handwriting does not.
- **Apparatus is set out and tested by an adult**, always. The violet *Stay safe* panel in 1.4 is written to the pupil, but the responsibility is the teacher's, and 1.4 is the topic in this unit where two movers share one space.



The gate at the end of the day. Kit put away without being asked, which is ground rule 8, and the chalk lines scuffed right through, which is the only real evidence that a morning was used properly.